j) What was the 'shameful act'?

k) Why didn't the narrator want to tell the tale to anybody?

l) Why did the narrator feel helpless?

m) Who was the real enemy?

2. Read the poem again and complete the summary using the words given in box.

Stanzas 1–3

'The Castle' by Edwin Muir is a moving poem on the (1)…….. of a well-guarded (2)…….. The soldiers of the castle were totally stress-free and relaxed. They were (3)……. of their castle's physical strength. Through the turrets they were able to watch the mowers and no enemy was found up to the distance of (4)……. and so they seemed no threat to the castle. They had (5)……. of weapons to protect them and a large quantity of (6)……. in stock to take care of the well-being of the soldiers inside the castle. The soldiers stood one above the other on the towering battlements (7)……. to shoot the enemy at sight. They believed that the castle was absolutely safe because their captain was (8)…….. and the soldiers were loyal.

| | |
|---|---|
| half-a-mile | watching |
| castle | brave |
| ration | capture |
| plenty | confident |

Stanzas 4–6

Even by a trick no one but the birds could enter. The enemy could not use a (9)…. for their entry inside the castle. But there was a wicket gate guarded by a (10)……. He (11)……. in the enemies inside the famous citadel that had been known for its secret gallery and intricate path. The strong castle became(12)…… and thin because of the greedy disloyal warder. The (13)…… was captured by the enemies for (14)……..The narrator (15)…… over the (16)…… of the useless warder and also decided not to disclose this (17)……..story to anyone. He was (18)……. and wondered how he would keep this truth to himself. He regretted not finding any (19)…… to fight with the (20)..... called 'gold'.

| | |
|---|---|
| lamented | shameful |
| wicked guard | bait |
| let | gold |
| weapon | citadel |
| weak | disloyalty |
| helpless | enemy |

3. Read the poem and answer the following in a short paragraph of 8-10 sentences each.

a) How safe was the castle? How was it conquered?

b) Bring out the contrasting picture of the castle as depicted in stanzas 3 and 5.

c) Human greed led to the mighty fall of the citadel. Explain.

4. Read the given lines and answer the questions that follow in a line or two.

a) *All through the summer at ease we lay,*
*And daily from the turret wall*
*We watched the mowers in the hay*

i. Who does 'we' refer to?

ii. How did the soldiers spend the summer days?

iii. What could they watch from the turret wall?



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